hybridizers of native plants and animals, ultimately threatening the survival of those species.



The harlequin ladybug is the world's most invasive ladybug. In the UK, where it was first seen in 2004, it is reportedly responsible for the decline of seven native ladybug species.

The rise of the rabbit

One of the most notable species invasions has been that of the European rabbit in Australia. It began in 1788, when 11 ships landed at Botany Bay from Britain, to establish the first Australian penal colony. On board the "First Fleet," along with more than 1,000 people, including convicts and emigrants, were six European rabbits, brought along for food.